Siyu Liang

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Education

2021 – Present **University of Washington** – Seattle, WA
Ph.D. in Computational Linguistics
Advisors: Drs. Gina-Anne Levow & Richard Wright

2025 **University of Washington** – Seattle, WA
M.S. in Computational Linguistics

2020 **Georgetown University** – Washington, DC
B.A. in Linguistics with minors in Persian & Computer Science
Advisor: Dr. Elizabeth Zsiga

Publications

Siyu Liang, Alicia Wassink. 2026 (to appear). "This Wasn't Made for Me": Recentering User Experience and Emotional Impact in the Evaluation of ASR Bias. In *Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT 2026)*, ACM, Montreal, Canada.

Siyu Liang, Nicolas Ballier, Gina-Anne Levow, Richard Wright. 2026 (to appear). The Limits of Data Scaling: Sub-token Utilization and Acoustic Saturation in Multilingual ASR. In *Proceedings of the 15th International Conference on Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC 2026)*, European Language Resources Association (ELRA), Palma de Mallorca, Spain.

Michael Scott, **Siyu Liang**, Alicia Wassink, Gina-Anne Levow. 2026 (to appear). A Sociophonetic Analysis of Racial Bias in Commercial ASR Systems Using the Pacific Northwest English Corpus. In *Proceedings of the 15th International Conference on Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC 2026)*, European Language Resources Association (ELRA), Palma de Mallorca, Spain.

Siyu Liang, Talant Mawkanuli, Gina-Anne Levow. 2026 (to appear). Hybrid Neural-LLM Pipeline for Morphological Glossing in Endangered Language Documentation: A Case Study of Jungar Tuvan. In *Proceedings of the 5th Workshop on NLP Applications to Field Linguistics (FieldMatters)*, Association for Computational Linguistics, Rabat, Morocco.

Siyu Liang, Zhaxi Zerong. 2026 (to appear). The Tonogenesis Continuum in Tibetan: A Computational Investigation. In *Proceedings of the 6th International Workshop on Computational Approaches to Language Change (LChange)*, Association for Computational Linguistics, Rabat, Morocco.

Siyu Liang, Nicolas Ballier, Gina-Anne Levow, Richard Wright. 2025. Beyond WER: Probing Whisper's Sub-token Decoder Across Diverse Language Resource Levels. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, Association for Computational Linguistics, Suzhou, China. SAC Highlight Award

Siyu Liang, Gina-Anne Levow. 2025. Breaking the Transcription Bottleneck: Fine-tuning ASR Models for Extremely Low-Resource Fieldwork Languages . In *Proceedings of the 4th Workshop on NLP Applications to Field Linguistics (FieldMatters)*, Association for Computational Linguistics, Vienna, Austria.

Siyu Liang, Gina-Anne Levow. 2025. Tone in Perspective: A Computational Typological Analysis of Tone Function in ASR. In *Proceedings of the 7th Workshop on Research in Computational Linguistic Typology and Multilingual NLP (SIGTYP)*, Association for Computational Linguistics, Vienna, Austria.

Siyu Liang. 2020. Documenting Eynu: A Case Study of Language Contact. In *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Penn Linguistics Conference*, Philedephia, USA.

Other Presentations

Siyu Liang. 2025. Acoustic Correlates of Performed Sexual Orientation in Thai Media. In *New Ways of Analysing Variation Asia Pacific (NWAV-AP 8)*, Singapore. (Oral presentation)

Siyu Liang. 2023. A Phonological Account of Intervocalic Voicing in Yangon Burmese. In *the 56th International Conference on Sino-Tibetan Languages and Linguistics (ICSTLL 56)*. (Oral presentation)

Siyu Liang. 2021. Incomplete Vowel Assimilation in Tehrani Persian. In *the 4th Conference of Central Asian Language and Linguistics (ConCALL-4).* (Oral presentation)

Teaching

Spring 2026 — LING 471: Computational Methods for Linguists, University of Washington (Instructor of Record)

Winter 2024 — LING 572: Advanced Statistical Methods in Natural Language Processing, University of Washington (Teaching Assistant)

Autumn 2023, Autumn 2025 — LING 570: Shallow Processing Techniques for Natural Language Processing, University of Washington (Teaching Assistant)

Spring 2023 — LING 471: Computational Methods for Linguists, University of Washington (Teaching Assistant, guest lecture on Statistics Basics for NLP)

Spring 2022, Autumn 2021 — LING 200: Introduction to Linguistics, University of Washington (Teaching Assistant, with teaching duties twice weekly)

Winter 2022 — LING 461: Syntax I (Grader)

Industry experience

01-03.2026 — **Centific** – Redmond, WA, USA
AI Speech Research Intern
Conducting research on Spoken Language Models and end-to-end speech dialogue systems. Developing evaluation pipelines covering ASR, speech reasoning, and generation tasks.

07-11.2020 — **ByteDance** – Beijing, China
NLP Engineer Intern
Building a FrameNet-based intent framework for large-scale dialog systems. Developing an extendable symbol set for multilingual NLP tasks.

Talks and tutorials

2025 Analyzing Whisper Across Diverse Language Resource Levels
Workshop on Promoting Fairness for Under-represented Languages in Multilingual LLMs, May 26 2025, Université Paris Cité and Online

2025 Languages of the Silk Road (Guest lecture)
MELC 268: Silk Road and Globalization, Spring 2025, University of Washington

2024 Tibetan Music (Guest lecture)
MELC 269: Music Cultures of the Silk Road, Winter 2024, University of Washington

Professional Service

Reviewer, *LREC 2026, ICML 2026*

Service

2025 Editor, *Proceedings of the 43rd West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*

2023 – 2024 Treasurer, *Linguistic Society of the University of Washington (LSUW)*

Technical skills

Programming languages
Proficient: Python
Familiar: C++, Java, JavaScript, R

Software
ELAN, Praat

Natural Languages
Proficient: Mandarin, English
Advanced: Persian, French (reading)
Intermediate: Thai, Tibetan, Vietnamese, Indonesian, Japanese
Elementary: Burmese, Uyghur, Uzbek, Arabic, Amharic, Turkish, Russian, Portuguese, Swahili
Experience: Chaghatay, Nepali, Mongolian, etc.
Fieldwork: Nobiin, Eynu, Persian, Tibetan, Tuvan

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